

# **CYBERSECURITY INCIDENT INVESTIGATION REPORT**

## **Spear-Phishing and Web Defacement Investigation**

*FramtidX Development Corp – Frognado in Valdoria  
Professional Portfolio Case Study*

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## 1. Executive Summary

This portfolio case study reconstructs a multi-stage incident involving website defacement, spear phishing, credential-related discovery, malicious remote-access links, and destructive activity against business data. The documented evidence identified a group referred to as Shadow Truth, while also raising an unresolved question about whether employee Alex Johnson was an insider threat or whether his account had been compromised.

## 2. Key Findings

### Web Defacement

The FramtidX Development Corp website was documented as having been defaced. Anita Bath, the Web Administrator, was associated with hostname MYZB-LAPTOP. The defacement was recorded at 2024-07-10T11:45:50Z.

| Attribute  | Observed Value                 |
|------------|--------------------------------|
| Employee   | Anita Bath                     |
| Username   | anbath                         |
| Email      | anita_bath@framtidxdevcorp.com |
| Hostname   | MYZB-LAPTOP                    |
| Role       | Web Administrator              |
| Defacement | 2024-07-10T11:45:50Z           |

### Phishing and Credential Discovery

Anita Bath received a suspicious link from alex\_johnson@framtidxdevcorp.com on 2024-06-26T15:16:20Z. The documented investigation later identified a command searching her Documents directory for password-related files and identified mypasswordsnstuff.txt as a relevant artifact.

Observed command: Get-ChildItem -Path C:\Users\anbath\Documents\\* -Include \*password\* -Recurse

### Malicious Infrastructure and Impact

The investigation documented suspicious IP addresses 239.72.6.37 and 239.72.6.38, as well as ronniesdankmemes.com, which was associated with uploaded content on the compromised website. A suspicious login URL on greenprojectnews.net was sent to Architecture department leads Alex Bjorn and Sofia Lindgreen. The notes state that the site was used to gain remote access to their computers and that SuperImportantMallProjectArchitecturalPlans.docx was deleted.

### Attribution Assessment

Alex Johnson was a major subject of the spear-phishing investigation: username aljohnson, hostname HWYH-LAPTOP, role Developer. The notes state that malicious links were sent to seven employees, including the CEO, from his email address. Two hypotheses remained:

insider involvement or prior compromise of his account. The available documentation does not conclusively resolve the attribution.

### 3. Reconstructed Timeline

| Time / Sequence      | Event                                                              |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024-06-26T15:16:20Z | Suspicious link received by Anita Bath from Alex Johnson's email.  |
| Subsequent activity  | Password-related file discovery documented.                        |
| Campaign activity    | Malicious login link sent to Architecture department leads.        |
| Post-access          | Remote access and deletion of architectural plans documented.      |
| 2024-07-10T11:45:50Z | Website defacement recorded.                                       |
| Ongoing              | Insider-threat versus compromised-account hypotheses investigated. |

### 4. Attack Chain Assessment

| Stage             | Assessment                                                              |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial Access    | Spear-phishing emails containing malicious links.                       |
| Credential Access | Search for password-related files documented.                           |
| Remote Access     | Malicious login infrastructure used against targeted personnel.         |
| Impact            | Website defacement and deletion of business data.                       |
| Attribution       | Legitimate employee account potentially abused; attribution unresolved. |

### 5. Indicators and Artifacts

- 239.72.6.37
- 239.72.6.38
- ronniesdankmemes.com
- greenprojectnews.net/online/images/modules/share/login.html
- alex\_johnson@framtidxdevcorp.com
- MYZB-LAPTOP
- HWYH-LAPTOP
- mypasswordsnstuff.txt
- SuperImportantMallProjectArchitecturalPlans.docx

## 6. Conclusion

The evidence supports a multi-stage intrusion involving spear phishing, credential-related discovery, remote access, website compromise, and destructive impact. A key analytical lesson is that suspicious activity originating from a legitimate employee account must not automatically be attributed to insider misconduct without corroborating evidence.

## 7. Recommended Response Actions

- Preserve email, authentication, endpoint, and web-server evidence.
- Reset and investigate potentially compromised accounts.
- Block and hunt for the identified malicious infrastructure.
- Review privileged web-administrator access and credential storage practices.
- Hunt for similar credential-discovery and remote-access activity enterprise-wide.
- Restore deleted data from validated backups and assess broader impact.